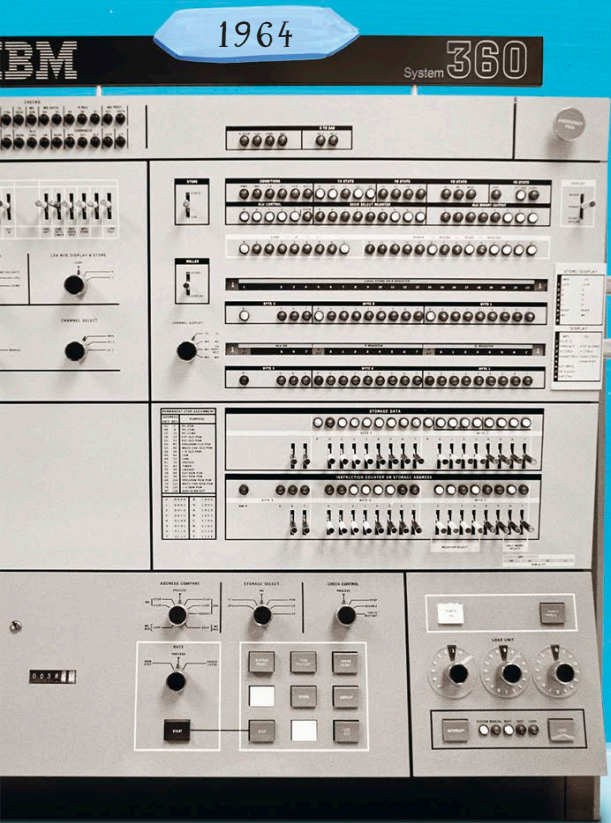




1964

System 360

IBM System/360

By the 1960s, electronic computers were affordable enough to be used by all kinds of businesses and labs. Business computers, such as the IBM System/360, could run different sets of instructions, called “programs,” so they could be used for lots of different tasks.

IBM Personal Computer

Once microprocessors were available, computers could be made small enough (and cheap enough) for people to have in their homes! This was one of the very first personal computers—or “PCs” for short.



1981



2000

Robots

A robot is a machine that works automatically, controlled by a computer. Robots do different jobs, including dull ones that humans might not want to do! In homes, robotic vacuum cleaners can clean, and in factories, robot arms assemble things.

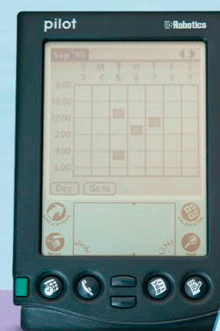
Portable computers

Thanks to new technology and materials, personal computers have become more powerful, easier to use, and smaller. Today, billions of people carry computers in their pockets that can do far more than ENIAC.

Early laptops in the 1980s looked more like desktop computers!



1981



1996

The first handheld computers went on sale in the 1990s.



Present

Smartphones are computers and telephones all in one.